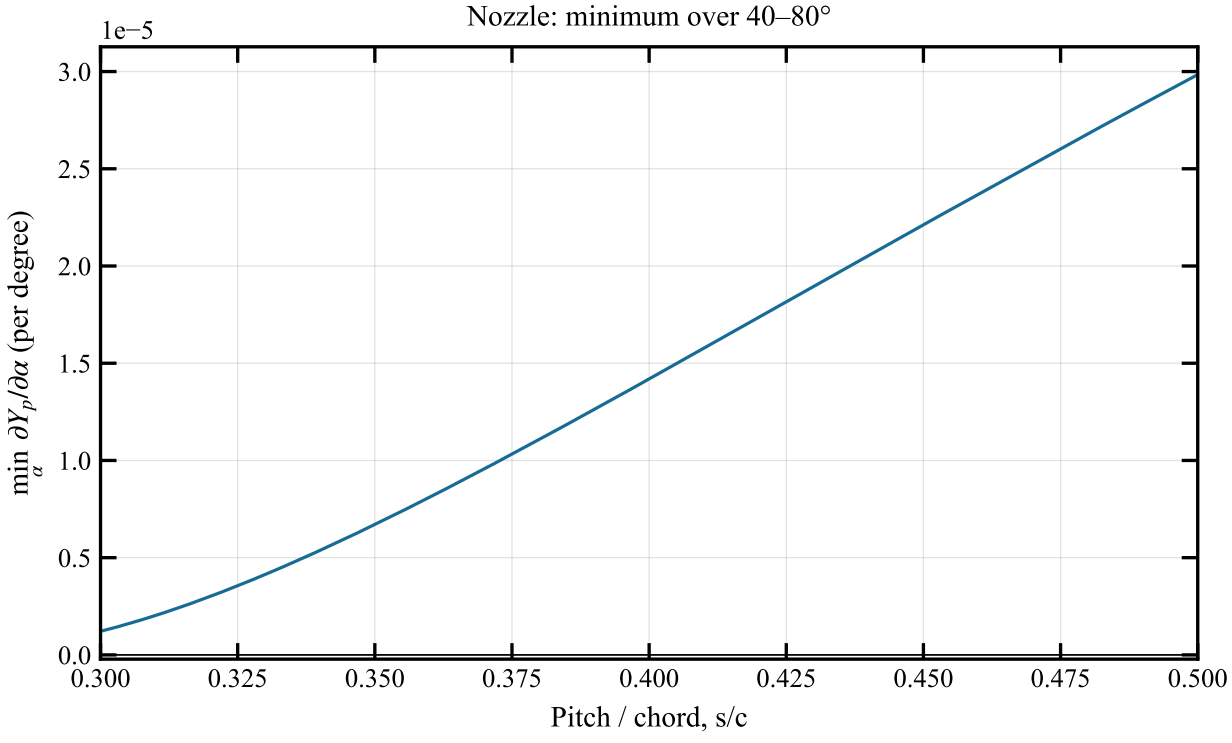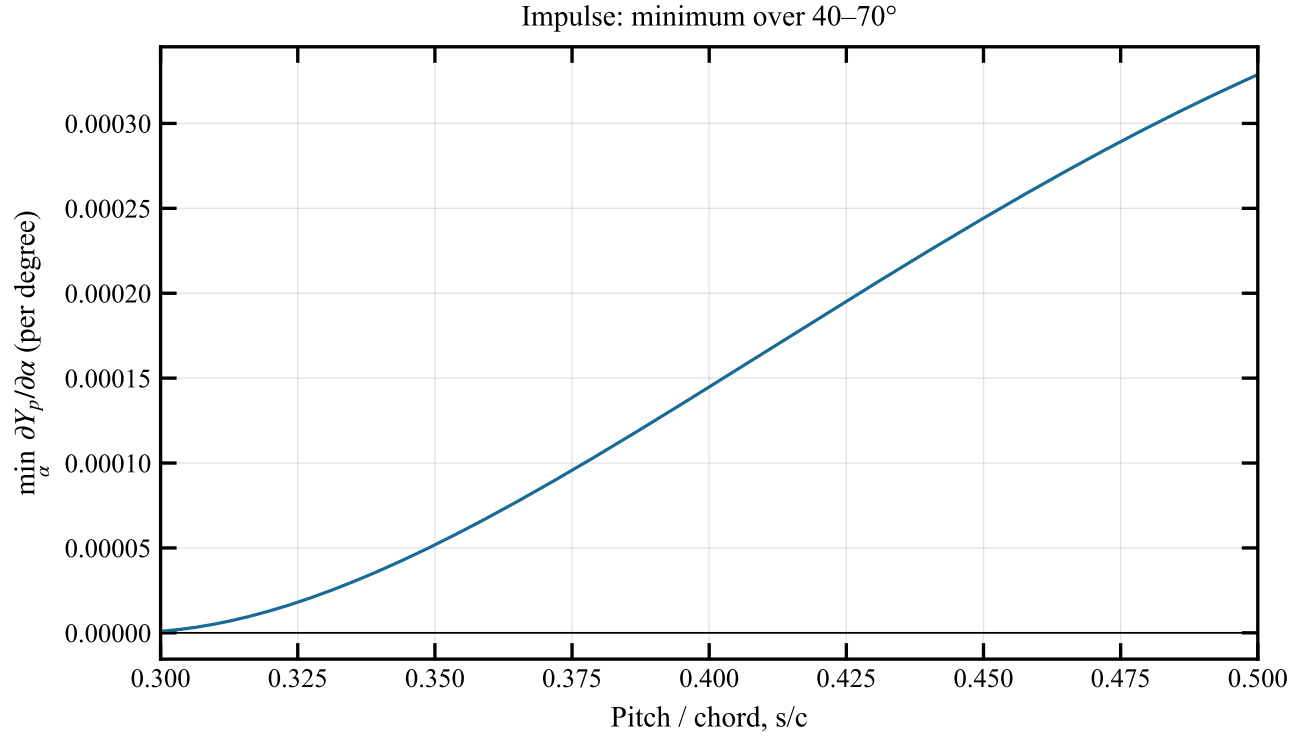Low-spacing angle-ordering check; nonnegative slope means no reversal